



firmly in its cheek, to the gracious art of taking tea. Etiquette and manners are explained for beginners and visitors alike, from the use of the sugar tongs to the allowable volume of conversation at the tea table, while on Sunday afternoons everyone rises for a rendition of "God Save the Queen."

Fortnum & Mason expensive

181 Piccadilly, London W1;
www.fortnumandmason.com

Few places can offer as wide a range of teas as Fortnum's, the fashionable London grocery store *par excellence* founded in 1707. Their tea department offers over 70 blends and single-estate teas, available as part of afternoon tea or a grander High Tea in the store's elegant St. James's restaurant.



The Ritz expensive

150 Piccadilly, London W1;
www.theritzhotel.co.uk

For many, there is simply no better place to experience the quintessential afternoon tea in all its pomp and glory than the Ritz Hotel's magnificent, gilded Palm Court. This is tradition poured straight from the pot and, as befits the surroundings, you are expected to dress up; no jeans or athletic shoes, and gentlemen require a jacket and tie.

NORTH AMERICA

Coffee has long been the more popular drink in North America, but across the US and in Canada there are Anglophiles and tea fanatics who keep alive the genteel traditions of a bygone age.

Crown & Crumpet Tea Salon

moderate

207 Ghirardelli Square, 900 North Point, San Francisco, CA;
www.crownandcrumpet.com

The Crown & Crumpet presents a mix of English wit and San Francisco style in a bright and breezy tearoom that offers a playful take on traditional afternoon tea. All the right ingredients are in place — well-sourced teas, homemade scones and cakes, toasted crumpets — but this creative California café is never in danger of taking itself too seriously.

Tea & Sympathy moderate

108 Greenwich Avenue, New York City, NY;
www.teaandsympathynewyork.com

Greenwich Village, original heart of New York's counterculture, is a melting pot of ideas and influences, including this self-styled "corner of

England," known for its home-away-from-home food. Scones and jam are always on the menu, alongside other teatime favorites like rarebit or sardines on toast, and the teas include both English-style house blends and specialty brews.

Fairmont Empress Hotel

expensive

721 Government Street, Victoria, British Columbia, Canada;
www.fairmont.com

For over a century, Victoria's dashing *grande dame* hotel has been serving afternoon tea with a harbor view in its glorious imperial lobby. There's every attention to detail, from tea tasting notes to the signature raisin scones that form the centerpiece of this most elegant of experiences.

ASIA

As the British Empire touched every corner of the world, so did the taste for a reviving mid-afternoon break. The English took tea back to its Eastern roots, and in Singapore, Hong Kong, and India, the ceremony lingers on in upmarket hotels.

Mandarin Oriental expensive

5 Connaught Road, Central, Hong Kong;
www.mandarinoriental.com

Even on the most hot and humid of days there's an air of calm in the Mandarin Oriental's legendary Clipper Lounge, where the great and good of Hong Kong come to see and be seen. Here, in one of the world's most renowned luxury hotels, afternoon tea is a truly magnificent repast, including artistic creations from the hotel's own patisserie.

Raffles Hotel expensive

1 Beach Road, Singapore;
www.affles.com

White-jacketed waiters glide effortlessly around the period-piece "Tiffin Room" in one of Southeast Asia's most emblematic hotels. Much like having a Singapore Sling (the iconic cocktail invented in the hotel), taking High Tea at Raffles is part of the whole colonial-revival experience and not to be missed.

Rambagh Palace expensive

Bhawani Singh Road, Jaipur, Rajasthan, India;
www.tajhotels.com

This former royal guest house and hunting lodge, later a Maharajah's palace and now a sumptuous hotel, makes for a wonderfully extravagant backdrop for afternoon tea. Pots of tea and dainty bites, impeccably presented, are served overlooking the stunning palace gardens.

